



VGH-Virtual Cardiac Rehab (VCR) Exercise Program – 6

In addition to your regular activities such as walking, try to incorporate these videos to your routine (click on the blue link). If you require any modification to the routines, speak with your case manager.

WARM UP Start with 5 minutes of light activity before starting any exercise routine. This may include a walk around your house, march on the spot and light dynamic movements and stretches.

AEROBIC ROUTINE Refer to the VGH cardiac rehab exercise program section in subsequent pages for basic instructions on exercise intensity, frequency, type and time.

Dance Routine (Standing Option): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8HN1DbBtTcA>

Dance Routine (Seated Option): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ogKIUrnZWUY>

RESISTANCE TRAINING Refer to the Resistance Training section in subsequent pages for general guidelines. The program has a 4-week cycle: Bodyweight, Dumbbells, Bands and Balance/Posture. If you do not have equipment, omit equipment and simply follow through the movements. You may continue to use equipment you do have and follow previous videos or instructions, if available.

Equipment Required: Dumbbell Routine (you can use weights, water bottles or soup cans)

Standing Dumbbell Routine: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eKKMYX5fjW4>

Seated Dumbbell Routine: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E188slxISG8>

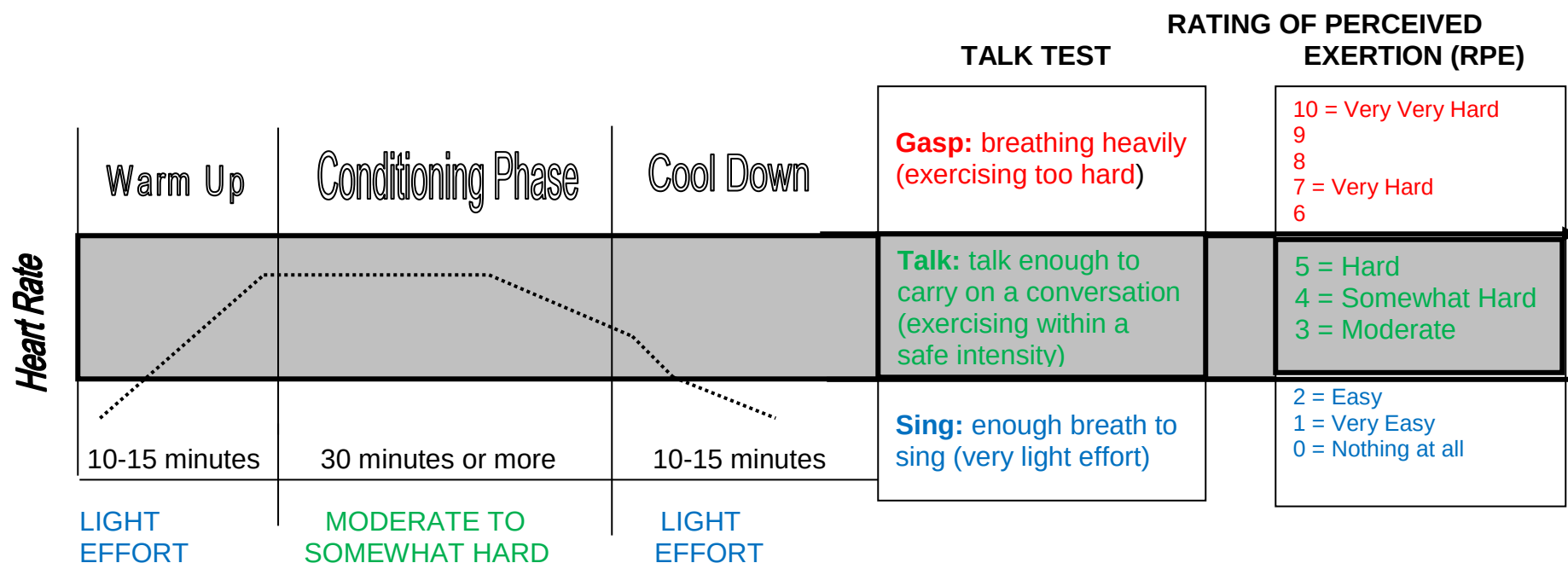
Printed/Graphic Exercises: Refer to the exercises found on the subsequent pages.

COOL DOWN Suggested stretching routine (printed/graphic exercises) are found on subsequent pages. Perform stretches pain-free, hold each stretch for 20-30 seconds and repeat 2-3 more times. Alternatively, you can try this seated yoga routine: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3ZvmKOPoFVo>

TIPS ON HOW TO MODIFY YOUR ROUTINE

TOO EASY	TOO HARD
Repeat the routine once more.	Pick one activity to do each day. Day 1: Aerobic; Day 2: Resistance; Day 3: Walk
Do the routine on consecutive days or no more than 1 rest day in between sessions.	Break up your routine through-out the day: Morning: Aerobic; Afternoon: Resistance; Evening Stretch
Combine 2 or 3 routines (Do aerobic, resistance and stretch back-to-back for a full hour of exercise).	Move through-out the day, such as walk around the house or stand more. Any movement is better than no movement.
Build up your volume by exercising more often (5 days/week), and/or longer (30 minutes or more).	Start with the Seated Options before progressing to the Standing Options.
Speak to your Case Manager for more challenging exercise options.	Speak to your Case Manager for less challenging exercise options.

VGH Cardiac Rehab Exercise Program



Frequency: Aim for exercise almost every day (5 days)

Intensity: As above and as tolerated. Listen to your body.

Time: Aim for 30 minutes or more; this can be done in bouts of 10-15 minutes or more.

Type: In home exercise; examples: videos, personal equipment

SIGNALS TO SLOW DOWN:

- ✗ if you have exceeded your target heart rate
- ✗ shortness of breath or difficulty breathing
- ✗ discomfort in chest, arm, back, jaw
- ✗ unusual joint or muscle pain
- ✗ irregular heart beats, dizziness, nausea

For health benefits, adults should accumulate *at least* **150 minutes** of moderate intensity aerobic **physical activity** per week, in bouts of 10 minutes or more. Add muscle and bone strengthening exercises 2 days per week (see General Tips for Strength Training)

General Tips for Strength Training

1. **Always warm up** your body with dynamic movements for 5-10 minutes; e.g. easy walk, light calisthenics and stretches.
2. **Never hold your breath!!** Do not bear down and hold your breath when lifting the weight. Breathe normally through-out the movement.
3. **Learn the movement and technique first.** Practice the movement with good technique and posture without a weight or with a lighter weight. Once you feel you've mastered the technique, add or increase the weight to achieve moderate muscle fatigue **AND** maintain good technique.
4. **Control the movement:** count two seconds to lift the weight and 3 seconds to lower the weight.
5. Choose a *pusher* exercise (chest press, modified push-up), a *puller* exercise (seated row, lat. Pull-downs, band row), and a *leg* exercise (leg press, squat, split squat).
6. **If you can't do 8 (repetitions), decrease the weight.** You should be able to lift your chosen weight comfortably at least 8 times and achieve moderate muscle fatigue with 10-15 repetitions.
7. **Progress in small increments.** Start by adding 1-2 repetitions. Once you can do 15-17 reps, then try adding weight (the smallest increment available) and do 10-15 reps.
8. 1-2 sets of 10-15 repetitions is enough to see improvements in strength when done 2-3 times per week. Be sure to take a day in between strength workouts to recover.
9. **If there's pain, there is no gain!** If a movement is causing pain, try adjusting the weight, position and technique with the help of an exercise professional. If pain continues, stop doing the exercise and seek medical opinion.

Tips for Using Free Weights

- Watch yourself in the mirror to make sure your technique is correct and form is good.
- Be careful when lifting the weight from the rack or the floor. Bend your elbows and your knees; lift with the legs as much as possible.
- Free weights can include dumbbells, water bottles or soup cans etc.

Goblet Squat (Dumbbell)

Sets: 1-3 | Reps: 10-15 | Rest: 60 seconds

Preparation:

- Stand with good posture, feet are shoulder width apart
- Hold dumbbell at chest as shown

Execution:

- Perform a squat by bending at the hip, then knees. Be sure heels do not lift away from the floor.
- Stop at the point where you cannot keep your lower back flat
- Rise up by straightening at the hip

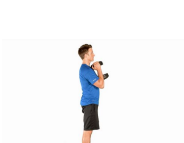
TIP: only squat as low as feels comfortable; listen to your body.



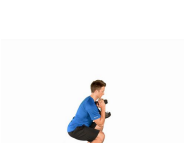
Feet shoulder width apart, dumbbell at chest



Squat - Bend at the hip, back flat



Stand with good posture



Knees project over toes

Bent Over Row | Close Grip (Dumbbells)

Sets: 1-3 | Reps: 10-15 | Rest: 60 seconds

Preparation:

- Go into a partial squat or sit on a chair
- Bend slightly forward, keeping the back and neck straight. Chin slightly tucked.
- Arms hang straight down
- Set your shoulders (think down and back)

Execution:

- Row straight into your stomach, keep elbows close to your sides, squeezing shoulder blades
- Slowly straighten the arms

TIP: this exercise can be done seated.



Partial squat



Row straight up



Squeeze shoulder blades

Chest Press | Alternating (Dumbbell)

Sets: 1-3 | Reps: 10-15 | Rest: 60 seconds

Preparation:

- Lie on bench (feel free to lie on your bed or the ground if you don't have a bench). Hold dumbbells at sides of chest, palms facing forward, elbows out to sides

Execution:

- Lift weight straight up on one side
- Lower weight down
- Press up with the opposite side



Arms out to side



Push one side up



Lower down with control



Press other side up

Shoulder Press | Unilateral (Dumbbell)

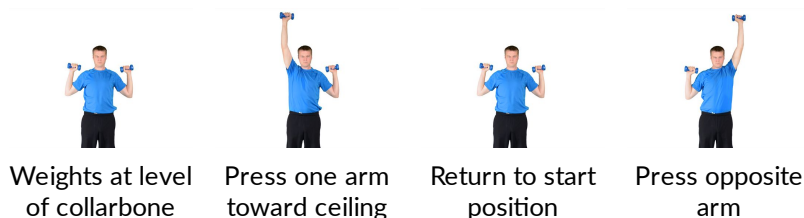
Sets: 1-3 | Reps: 10-15 | Rest: 60 seconds

Preparation

- Stand with good posture, feet shoulder width apart.
- Hold weights at level of collarbone, elbows bent.

Execution

- Push weight straight up, toward ceiling, straightening arm.
- Slowly return to the start position.



Elbow Flexion (Dumbbell)

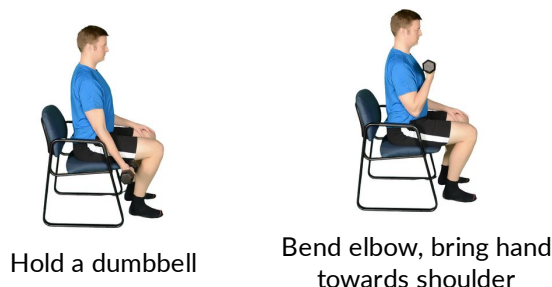
Sets: 1-3 | Reps: 10-15 | Rest: 60 seconds

Preparation:

- Sit with good posture holding a free weight

Execution:

- Bend your elbow, bringing hand towards shoulder
- Return to start position in a controlled manner



Elbow Extension Concentric | Bent Over (Dumbbell)

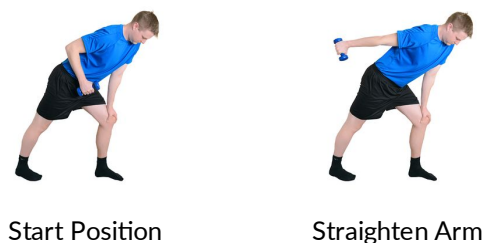
Sets: 1-3 | Reps: 10-15 each side | Rest: 60 seconds

Preparation:

- Bend forward, keeping back and neck straight, shoulders back
- You can do this standing (as shown) or seated in a chair

Execution:

- Keeping your elbow at your side, straighten your arm backwards
- Slowly return to the start position



Single Leg Stance | Supported (Wall)

Sets: 2-3 | Hold: 15-30 Seconds

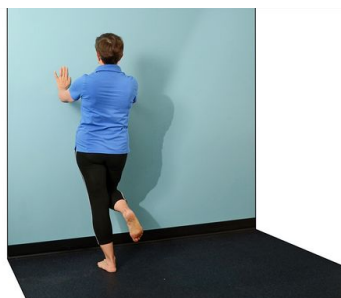
Preparation:

- Stand facing a wall or counter, holding for support

Execution:

- Stand on one leg and balance

To make this more challenging, try only using fingertips on the wall or counter



Balance on one leg, hold wall for support

Stretching Routine

Perform this routine throughout the week to reduce joint stiffness. Remember the stretch should not be painful. Speak with your case manager if you require any modifications. Remember to breathe!

Posterior Shoulder Stretch

Sets: 2-3 | Hold: 30-60s

Preparation:

- Sit or stand with good posture

Execution:

- Reach across your chest
- Use your other arm to pull a bit further



*Head and eyes forward,
belly button pulled in*



Reach arm across body



*Place opposite hand at
elbow, gradually pull to
stretch the back of your
shoulder*

Rhomboid Stretch

Sets: 2-3 | Hold: 30-60s

Preparation

- Clasp your hands in front of you at shoulder height

Execution:

- Push your hands away from your body
- At the same time pull your shoulders towards your hands
- You should feel a stretch in your upper back



Claps hands



*Push hands and
shoulders forward*

Upper Trapezius Stretch | Overpressure

Sets: 2-3 | Hold: 30-60s

Preparation:

- Sit on your hand on the side to be stretched
- Alternatively, you can grab under chair

Execution:

- Bring your chin to chest and look to opposite corner, angling your ear toward your armpit
- To feel an increased stretch, use your opposite hand to guide your head further into the stretch



Start position



Ear to armpit

Swimmer's Stretch

Sets: 2-3 | Hold: 30-60s

Execution:

- Lock fingers behind back; elbows straight
- To increase the stretch, lift your arms backward



*Lock fingers behind back
- To increase the stretch,
lift your arms backward*

Hamstring Stretch

Sets: 2-3 | Hold: 30-60s

Preparation:

- Sit on the edge of a chair

Execution:

- Put one leg out front
- Keep your knee locked
- Lean forward from the hips
- You should feel a stretch in the back of your leg



*Eyes and head forward,
hands resting on thigh,
toes toward the ceiling*



*Hinge at hips to feel
stretch in the back of the
thigh*

Quadriceps Stretch (Chair)

Sets: 2-3 | Hold: 30-60s

Preparation:

- Stand behind a chair

Execution:

- Lift your heel towards your buttock and hold the top of your ankle with your hand, balancing on one leg
- Straighten your hip to increase the stretch across the top of your thigh



*Pull heel to buttocks -
avoid arching back*

Piriformis Stretch - Bottom Leg Straight

Sets: 2-3 | Hold: 30-60s

Preparation:

- Lie on back

Execution:

- Bring knee towards your opposite shoulder



Start Position



Grab knee with hands



Bring knee toward opposite shoulder

Calf Stretch Foot on Wall

Sets: 2-3 | Hold: 30-60s

Preparation:

- Stand close to a wall
- Place bottom of foot up on the wall
- Heel is on the floor

Execution:

- Lean forward until you feel a stretch in your calf



Toes against wall, heel on floor, lean forward